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Lump sum funding in SP-EU

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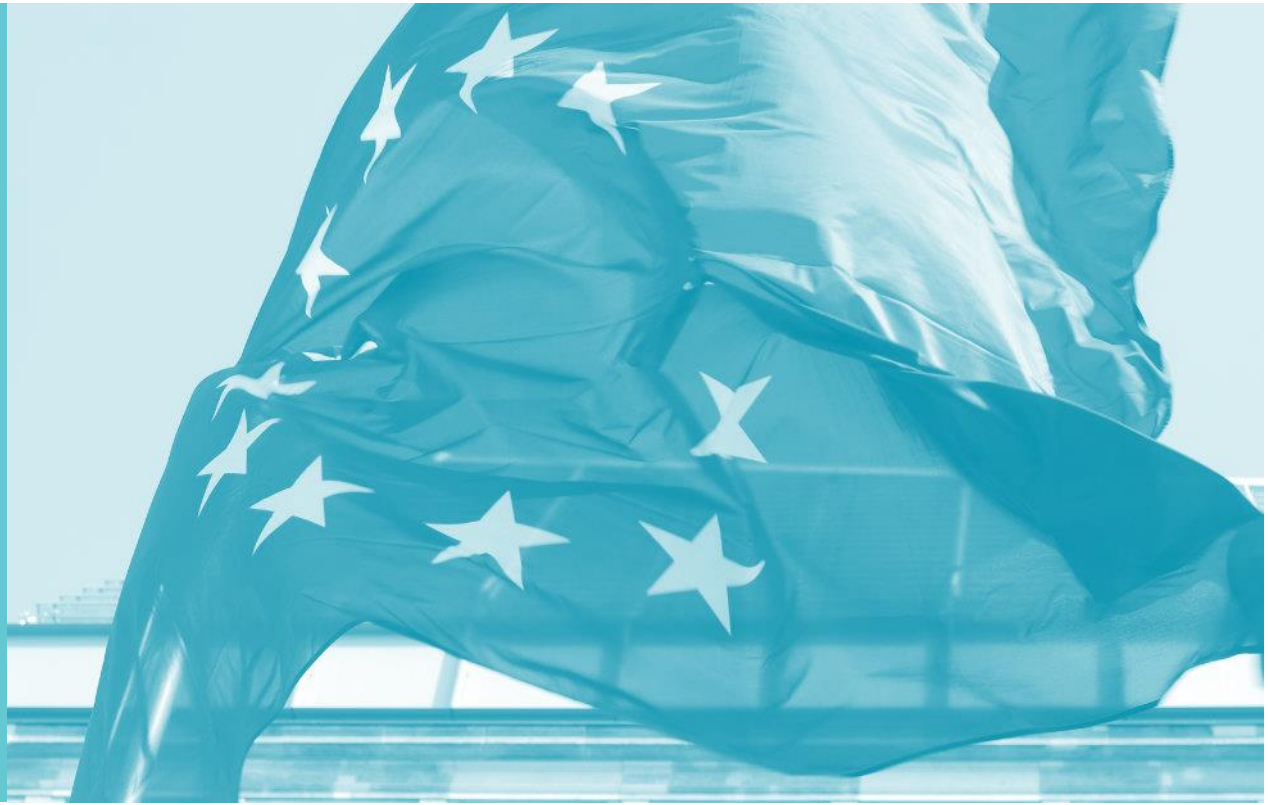

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Basic Principles and Advantages

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H2020 vs. HE: Most of the rules and templates are still the same!

- Page limit of full-stage proposal: 50 pages (for lump sum grants)

- Finances: Use of lump sums
- Lump sum project funding removes all obligations on actual cost reporting and financial ex-post audits: a major reduction of administrative burden!
- Changes in budget and work package structure

Some of the following screen shots are from the European Commission – for further information, please see link: https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ls-funding-what-do-i-need-to-know_he_en.pdf

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Basic principles

Lump sum evaluation and grant agreement (GA) follow the standard approach with the same

1. Evaluation criteria
2. Pre-financing and payment scheme
3. Reporting periods and technical reporting – **the focus lies on the completion of WPs**

One lump sum share is fixed in the GA for each WP:

➢ WP completed → Payment

- **Payments do not depend on successful outcome, but on the completion of activities**
- **WPs can be modified through amendments (e.g. new scientific developments, etc.)**

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Lump Sum Grant Management

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Project Design - Workpackages

WP distribution:

As many as needed but no more than what is manageable

A WP is a major sub-division of the work plan of our project

- A single activity is not a WP
- A single task is not a WP
- A % of progress is not a WP (e.g. 50% of the tests)
- A lapse of time is generally not a WP (e.g. activities of year 1)

WPs with a long duration can be split along the reporting periods: e.g. Project Management WP and Dissemination & Exploitation WP

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Budget Allocation

	WP1	WP2	WP3	WP4	WP5	WP6	WP7	WP8	Total
Beneficiary A	250.000			50.000	300.000	250.000		300.000	1.150.000
Beneficiary B		250.000	350.000	50.000			100.000	150.000	900.000
Beneficiary C	100.000	100.000		50.000		280.000			530.000
Beneficiary D		120.000		50.000			100.000	150.000	420.000
Total	350.000	470.000	350.000	200.000	300.000	530.000	200.000	600.000	**3.000.000**

Shares of the lump sum per beneficiary

Shares of the lump sum per WP

Lump sum
=
Maximum grant amount

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Interim reportings and payments

1) At the end of the reporting period, declare which WPs have been completed.
The technical report should justify this.

2) Following the assessment of the report, the lump sum shares corresponding to approved WPs are paid.

	WP1	WP2	WP3	WP4	WP5
Beneficiary A	250.000			50.000	300.000
Beneficiary B		250.000	350.000	50.000	
Beneficiary C	100.000	100.000		50.000	
Beneficiary D		120.000		50.000	
Total	350.000	470.000	350.000	200.000	300.000

Annex 2

	WP1	WP2	WP3	WP4	WP5
Beneficiary A	Completed			Not completed	Not completed
Beneficiary B		Completed	Completed	Not completed	
Beneficiary C	Completed	Not completed		Not completed	
Beneficiary D		Completed		Completed	

State of play at the end of the reporting period

	WP1	WP2	WP3	WP4	WP5
Beneficiary A	250.000			50.000	300.000
Beneficiary B		250.000	350.000	50.000	
Beneficiary C	100.000	100.000		50.000	
Beneficiary D		120.000		50.000	
Total	350.000	470.000	350.000	200.000	300.000

Annex 2

✓ ✗ ✓ ✗

Payment = 350 000 + 0 + 350 000 + 0 = 700 000 €

Payment does not depend on a successful outcome, but on the **completion of activities**

→ Limited to 90% of the total grant (10% final payment)

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Keeping records

You **need** (e.g.)	You **don't need**
Technical documents	Time-sheets
Publications, prototypes, deliverables	Pay-slips or contracts
Documentation required by good research practices such as lab books	Depreciation policy
…any document proving that the work was done as detailed in Annex 1	Invoices
	…actual costs

Same as for all Horizon Europe grants

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Summary

- No reporting of actual costs, no financial checks and audits
- Following the evaluation of the proposal, lump sum shares are defined per beneficiary and per WP and are fixed in the GA
- Pre-financing as usual
- Payments upon completion of reporting periods

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How to fill in the lump sum table

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Lump sum table in practical terms

- After the Berlin workshop, concentris will prepare the excel template for lump sums for each partner in SP-EU
- All partners will receive detailed instructions on
  - which WPs they are involved in
  - how many person-months are foreseen for different employees
  - instructions on how “other costs" should be allocated (travel and subsistence; equipment; other goods, works and services, etc.)

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Excel template: few instructions before starting

EUROPEAN COMMISSION
DIRECTORATE-GENERAL FOR RESEARCH & INNOVATION

Annex: detailed estimation of costs for Lump Sum funding

Instructions

Go to Beneficiaries and Affiliated Entities list | Go to Work packages list

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

This workbook enables you to present the detailed estimation of costs of your lump sum project and to calculate the lump sum breakdown per work package and per category. It must be uploaded as an additional document at "Fill in proposal" step of proposal submission. This is mandatory. Please note that if you do not upload the Excel workbook, the proposal submission will be blocked.

According to the lump sum scheme, the lump sum share for a Work Package (WP) will be paid only when the entire Work Package has been completed. Please take it into consideration while structuring your proposal. Work Packages should be designed in a way that enables to clearly identify whether the action has been completed.

We recommend using Excel 2010 or more recent.

The only currency used in this workbook is EURO.

Enter only **round numbers** in this workbook.

You have to fill in **only** the following sheets: 'BE list' – 'WP list' – 'BEx' (one sheet for each Beneficiary) – 'Depreciation costs' (if any) and the column D 'requested grant amount' of the 'Budget for proposal sheet'.
The appropriate number of individual Beneficiary sheets ('BEx') will be automatically generated with data from the 'BE list' and 'WP list' sheets.

You will have to fill in the 'Budget for the proposal' table in the Part A form of the proposal submission tool, entering the requested EU contribution for each participant. We advise you to fill this Part A budget table column using the totals in the beneficiaries columns of the "Lump sum breakdown" table in this Excel workbook.

The format of this Excel workbook is **.xlsm** because it uses macros to generate automatically some data. **Always save it as .xlsm.**
However, this format cannot be uploaded to the submission system for security reasons.
So please also **save a copy** as an **.xlsx** or **.xls** document (and not as .xlsm) and upload it to the proposal submission tool, at Step 5 of the submission process.
Always keep a copy of the original .xlsm file.

Instructions | BE list | WP list | Lump sum breakdown | Summary per WP | BE1 | BE2 | BE3 | BE-WP person months | Depreciation costs | Any comments

- We recommend to use **Excel 10** or a more recent version
- The currency used in the template is **EURO**
- Read the **detailed instructions** on the first tab of the template

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Beneficiary calculation sheet

	A	B	C	D
1	BENEFICIARY CALCULATION SHEET			
2	summary	BENEFICIARY 1: Beneficiary 1		
3	COST CATEGORY	UNITS	COST PER UNIT	BE TOTAL COSTS
5	COSTS WORK PACKAGE 1: Work Package 1			
7	A. DIRECT PERSONNEL COSTS			
8	A.1 Employees (or equivalent)			
9	SENIOR SCIENTISTS (or equivalent in the private sector)			0,00
10	JUNIOR SCIENTISTS (or equivalent in the private sector)			0,00
11	TECHNICAL PERSONNEL (or equivalent in the private sector)			0,00
12	ADMINISTRATIVE PERSONNEL (or equivalent in the private sector)			0,00
13	OTHERS			0,00
14	A.2 Natural Persons under direct contract			0,00
15	A.3 Seconded Persons			0,00
16	A.4 SME owners and natural person beneficiaries		5.080,00	0,00

- **Every partner needs to fill in his/her „BEx“ sheet** (this will be prepared by concentris).
- Enter only the **number of units** and the **cost per unit** for each cost category (yellow cells). The total costs per cost category is calculated automatically.
- **1 unit = 1 person-month**
- For the cost per unit, enter **only whole numbers**.
- Cost categories are fixed and cannot be renamed. Use the „**Comment“ tab** in order to explain your costs in more detail (→ e.g. higher personnel costs as ususal).

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Direct purchase costs

19	**C. DIRECT PURCHASE COSTS**			
20	**C.1 Travel and subsistence**	2,00	650,00	**1.300,00**
21	**C.2 Equipment (complete 'Depreciation costs' sheet)**			
22	***Equipment***	1,00	450,00	**450,00**
23	***Infrastructure***			**0,00**
24	***Other assets***			**0,00**
25	**C.3 Other goods, works and services**			
26	***Consumables***	4,00	1000,00	**4.000,00**
27	***Services for meetings, seminars***	1,00	3000,00	**3.000,00**
28	***Services for dissemination activities (including website)***			**0,00**
29	***Publication fees***	2,00	1000,00	**2.000,00**
30	***Other (shipment, insurance, translation, etc.)***			**0,00**

- Enter **the total number of units** and the **average cost per unit** for each relevant cost category
- The cost per unit will be an average of the prices of all items in the given category for a given beneficiary and a given WP.
- If **purchase costs exceed 15% of the personnel costs** ➡ table 3.1h in Part B must be completed (will be done by concentris).

Table 3.1h: 'Purchase costs' items (travel and subsistence, equipment and other goods, works and services)

Participant Number/Short Name		
	Cost (€)	Justification
Travel and subsistence		
Equipment		
Other goods, works and services		
Remaining purchase costs (<15% of pers. costs)		
Total		

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In practicle terms – reach out to us and we will help!

- Lump sum grants are new and follow a different logic – challenging but the advantages are obvious
- Please inform your finance departments as soon as possible and send Sara and me their contact details
- We try to make everything as easy for you as possible!
- Do not hesitate to contact Sara or me in case of questions:
  - Sara Stöber: sara.stoeber@concentris.de // 0049 8141 625 285 73
  - Andrea Wohner: andrea.wohner@concentris.de // 0049 8141 625 285 75

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Part A – update and reminder

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Part A –update and reminder

Link: https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/home

- Reminder and comments sent on 16/02/2024
- Please finalise the Forms A as soon as possible so that we can „tick“ this administrative part of the proposal
- In case of questions, please contact
  - E: andrea.wohner@concentris.de
  - T: +49 8141 625 285 75

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Questions?

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DO YOU HAVE ANY QUESTIONS?